EASY STUDY NOTES

Human Resource Management

Every topic explained simply — with an example

Module 1 · Strategic HRM (Sessions 1 & 2)

Module 2 · Recruitment & Selection (Sessions 3 & 4)

Module 3 · International HRM: From Expatriates to Digital Nomads

Module 4 · Mentoring and Coaching

Based on course material by Prof. Prantika Ray, IIM Kozhikode

How to read these notes. Each topic has up to four coloured boxes: **What the slide says** (the textbook point), **In simple words** (the everyday meaning), **Example** (a real-life situation) and **Remember** (a quick exam tip). Each module ends with a one-page quick-revision summary.

Contents

Strategic Human Resource Management 4

1.1 Roadmap — what this module covers . . . 4
1.2 Why HR strategy must be a source of competitive advantage . . . 4
1.3 The Resource-Based View (RBV) of the firm . . . 5
1.4 The VRIO framework . . . 5
1.5 Strategic fit — the five fits . . . 6
1.6 The integrative model of HR strategy . . . 8
1.7 The four HR strategy archetypes . . . 8
Module 1 — Quick revision . . . 10

Recruitment & Selection 11

2.1 Overview — recruitment vs selection . . . 11
2.2 What is recruitment? . . . 11
2.3 What is effective recruitment? . . . 12
2.4 Person–Environment (P-E) fit . . . 12
2.5 The Attraction–Selection–Attrition (ASA) framework . . . 13
2.6 Building the candidate pool . . . 13
2.7 Internal sources of recruitment . . . 14
2.8 External sources of recruitment . . . 14
2.9 Measuring source effectiveness . . . 15
2.10 Job redesign . . . 15
2.11 Workforce planning . . . 16
2.12 Personnel needs projection (how many people will we need?) . . . 16
2.13 The recruiting yield pyramid . . . 16
2.14 Why is employee selection important? . . . 17
2.15 How structured are interviews? . . . 17
2.16 Interview content: four question types . . . 18
2.17 How interviews are conducted (formats) . . . 18
2.18 Types of selection tests . . . 19
2.19 Reliability of selection tests . . . 19
2.20 Validity of selection tests . . . 19
2.21 Errors and biases in selection . . . 20
2.22 Key takeaways . . . 20
Module 2 — Quick revision . . . 21

International HRM: From Expatriates to Digital Nomads 22

3.1 Session plan and the opening question “Would you go?” . . . 22
3.2 How international work has evolved . . . 22
3.3 Three faces of international work . . . 23
3.4 Why do organisations send people abroad? . . . 23
3.5 Who goes? The staffing vocabulary . . . 24
3.6 Types of international assignments . . . 24
3.7 Staffing mindsets — EPRG (Perlmutter) . . . 26
3.8 Spotting ethnocentrism in everyday practice . . . 26
3.9 A comprehensive model of international adjustment . . . 27
3.10 Dual allegiance — where does the expatriate’s heart lie? . . . 28
3.11 The U-curve of adjustment . . . 28
3.12 The J-curve — not everyone gets a honeymoon . . . 29
3.13 Intelligent career competencies (knowing-why, -how, -whom) . . . 29
3.14 How academic exposure builds career competencies (Propositions 1–3) . . . 30
3.15 Length versus breadth of experience (Propositions 4–5) . . . 30
3.16 What this means for global talent management . . . 31
3.17 Combining lifelines to thrive — a stage-based need-fulfilment network . . . 31
3.18 Mini case: Meera in Frankfurt (fictional) . . . 32
3.19 Five ideas to take away . . . 32
3.20 Key references (for citing in answers) . . . 33
Module 3 — Quick revision . . . 33

Mentoring and Coaching 34

4.1 Mentoring — two people, one developmental relationship . . . 34
4.2 Why? What is in it for the mentor? . . . 34
4.3 What? The two functions of mentoring . . . 35
4.4 Who? Who becomes your mentor — or your mentee? . . . 36
4.5 Making it work — three anchors for the relationship . . . 36
4.6 How? Build a developmental network . . . 36
4.7 Over time — how a mentoring relationship unfolds . . . 37
4.8 Reflect — questions for your own mentoring map . . . 37
Module 4 — Quick revision . . . 38

MODULE 1

Strategic Human Resource Management

Sessions 1 & 2 — Strategic fit, the Resource-Based View, and the design of HR strategy

1.1 Roadmap — what this module covers

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Session 1: why HR strategy must be a source of competitive advantage; the Resource-Based View (RBV) of the firm; the VRIO framework.

Session 2: the five fits (environmental, vertical, internal, intra-function, intra-activity); the integrative model of HR strategy; four HR strategy archetypes (commitment, collaborative, paternalistic, traditional).

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Session 1 answers **“Why are people a company’s secret weapon?”** Session 2 answers **“How do we design HR so that everything lines up with the business?”**

EXAMPLE

Think of a cricket team. Session 1 is about realising that your players (not the stadium or the kit) win matches. Session 2 is about making sure selection, training, coaching and rewards all support the team’s game plan.

1.2 Why HR strategy must be a source of competitive advantage

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

HR strategy should help the firm do better than its rivals, not just carry out a strategy decided elsewhere.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Competitive advantage = anything that helps a company beat its competitors — more customers, more profit, faster growth.

Older thinking treated HR as admin (payroll, leave, joining forms). Strategic HRM says HR should **create** the edge, because skilled, motivated people are hard for rivals to copy.

EXAMPLE

Two airlines buy the same aircraft from the same supplier. What makes customers prefer one? Usually the staff — friendly crew, on-time ground teams, quick problem-solving. That difference comes from HR: who is hired, how they are trained and rewarded.

1.3 The Resource-Based View (RBV) of the firm

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

RBV (Barney, 1991, *Journal of Management*): sustained competitive advantage comes mainly from **resources and capabilities inside the firm**, not only from its position in the outside market.

Chain: **Firm resources → Distinctive capabilities → Sustained competitive advantage**.

For HR: people, culture and organisational routines are **strategic assets**, not just a cost centre.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Look **inside** the company, not only outside. Ask: "What do we have that others don't?"

Resources = what you have (people, knowledge, brand, money). **Capabilities** = what you can do well with them. A special capability, kept up over time, becomes a **lasting** advantage.

Cost centre = a department seen only as spending money. RBV says HR is an **investment**, not just a cost.

EXAMPLE

A small sweet shop that has been famous for 50 years. Anyone can buy sugar, milk and an oven (outside resources). What rivals can't easily get is the family's recipe knowledge and experienced halwais trained over decades — that inside resource is its advantage.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

RBV = **inside-out** view. Resources → Capabilities → Sustained advantage. Author: **Barney (1991)**.

1.4 The VRIO framework

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

VRIO tests whether a resource can deliver competitive advantage. The four questions are asked in order; a resource must pass all four for **sustained** advantage.

Letter	Question	Result if it stops here	Example
Valuable	Does it help use an opportunity or fight a threat?	No → competitive **disadvantage**	Staff trained in an outdated software no one uses → not valuable.
Rare	Do only a few competitors have it?	Valuable but common → competitive **parity** (just equal)	All banks have staff who can operate ATMs → valuable but not rare.
Inimitable	Is it costly/hard for others to copy?	Rare but copyable → **temporary** advantage	A new app feature: rare today, but rivals copy it in 6 months.
Organised	Is the firm set up to capture its value?	All four yes → **sustained** competitive advantage	A culture of trust built over 30 years, backed by HR systems that reward it.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
Think of four gates. **Useful? → Rare? → Hard to copy? → Is the company organised to use it?** Only something that passes all four gates gives a long-lasting edge.

EXAMPLE
Tata's reputation for trust and ethics: valuable (customers and employees prefer it), rare, very hard to copy (built over 150 years), and organised (the group's policies and culture protect it). So it gives sustained advantage.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)
Order matters: V → R → I → O. Outcomes in order: disadvantage → parity → temporary advantage → sustained advantage.

1.5 Strategic fit — the five fits

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Five kinds of fit decide whether the HR system **reinforces** or **undermines** the organisation's strategy.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
"Fit" simply means things **match and support each other**, like gears in a machine. If one gear turns the wrong way, the whole machine jams.

Fit 1 — Environmental fit

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
The link between HR practices and the **external environment**. The HRM system should suit the social, cultural and institutional features of the environment.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
HR must suit the **outside world** — the country's laws, culture, unions and social expectations.

EXAMPLE
A US company that allows "hire and fire at will" can't copy that policy in India, where labour laws protect workers. Its Indian unit must design HR to fit Indian law and culture (e.g. festival bonuses, Diwali holidays).

Fit 2 — Vertical strategic fit

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Also called strategic fit: the link between the HR system and the **business strategy**. HR practices must build employees' capabilities and motivation to achieve the mission, vision and key goals.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
HR must match the **business plan** (from the top of the company down to HR).

EXAMPLE
If a hotel's strategy is "luxury service", HR should hire polite, well-groomed people, train them in hospitality and reward customer delight. If a budget hotel's strategy is "lowest cost", HR focuses on efficient, multi-skilled staff and tight cost control.

Fit 3 — Internal organisational fit

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Alignment between the HRM system and **other internal systems** — technology, structure, work systems, production systems and culture.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
HR must match **how the company actually works inside**.

EXAMPLE
A factory moves to automated machines. HR must now hire and train technicians who can run and repair robots — not just manual labourers. If HR keeps hiring for old methods, it doesn't fit the new technology.

Fit 4 — Intra-function HR fit

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
The link **between different HR practices** within the HR system. HR is strategic when practices don't contradict each other but complement and reinforce each other.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
All the HR activities (hiring, training, appraisal, pay) must **agree with each other**.

EXAMPLE
A company trains people heavily in teamwork, but the appraisal ranks individuals against each other and gives bonuses only to the top one. Training says "co-operate", appraisal says "compete" — a bad intra-function fit.

Fit 5 — Intra-activity HR fit

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Coordination of policies, activities and actions **within one particular HR activity**. E.g. compensation must be consistent across all its related practices.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
Even **inside a single HR area**, the parts must agree.

EXAMPLE
Inside the pay system: base salary rewards performance, but the annual increment is the same for everyone and the bonus is based only on years of service. The three parts of pay send different messages — poor intra-activity fit.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

- **Environmental** = HR ↔ outside world
- **Vertical** = HR ↔ business strategy
- **Internal** = HR ↔ other internal systems
- **Intra-function** = one HR practice ↔ another HR practice
- **Intra-activity** = parts within one HR practice

Memory trick: move from **outside** (environment) to **top** (strategy) to **inside** (organisation) to **within HR** to **within one HR activity**.

1.6 The integrative model of HR strategy

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

The five fits explain *why* HR must align; the integrative model explains *how* to choose a coherent HR strategy using two dimensions:

- **Acquisition and development (Internal ↔ External):** develop human capital inside, or rely on recruiting from outside?
- **Locus of workplace control (Process ↔ Outcomes):** monitor compliance with process standards, or control the end results?

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Two simple questions: **1. "Make or buy people?"** — grow your own talent or hire ready-made talent. **2. "Watch the method or watch the result?"** — check *how* work is done, or only *what* is achieved.

The two answers place a company in one of four boxes (next topic).

EXAMPLE

Infosys training thousands of freshers at its Mysuru campus = **internal/make**. A start-up hiring an experienced CFO from a big firm = **external/buy**. A call centre checking every call against a script = **process** control. A sales team judged only on monthly sales = **outcome** control.

1.7 The four HR strategy archetypes

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Source: Bratton & Gold (2014), based on Bamberger & Meshoulam (2000).

	Control OUTCOMES (results)	Control PROCESS (rules)
INTERNAL (make / develop)	**Commitment**	**Paternalistic**
EXTERNAL (buy / recruit)	**Collaborative**	**Traditional**

Commitment HR strategy (Internal + Outcomes)

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Focuses on internal development of employees' competencies and on outcome control.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

"We grow our own people and trust them — just deliver the results."

EXAMPLE
Google-style tech firms: invest heavily in training and careers, give people freedom in how they work, and judge them on results (goals/OKRs).

Collaborative HR strategy (External + Outcomes)

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Subcontracts work to external independent experts (consultants, contractors); gives greater autonomy; evaluates mainly by end results.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
“We bring in outside experts for the job and judge only the final output.”

EXAMPLE
A company hires McKinsey to design its growth strategy, or a freelance agency to build its website. It doesn’t supervise how they work — only checks the final report or website.

Paternalistic HR strategy (Internal + Process)

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Offers learning opportunities and internal promotion in return for employees’ compliance with process-based controls.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
Like a protective parent: “We’ll train you and promote you from within — as long as you follow our rules and procedures.”

EXAMPLE
Indian Railways or a traditional public-sector bank: secure jobs, training, promotion by seniority, but strict rules and procedures on how everything is done.

Traditional HR strategy (External + Process)

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Focuses on external recruitment of competencies and on behavioural (process-based) controls.

IN SIMPLE WORDS
“Hire people who already have the skills, then make them follow fixed procedures.”

EXAMPLE
A fast-food chain hiring trained cooks from the market and requiring them to follow exact step-by-step recipes and timing rules.

Module 1 — Quick revision

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

- HR can be a **source of competitive advantage**, not just a cost centre.
- **RBV** (Barney, 1991): advantage comes from inside resources → capabilities → sustained advantage.
- **VRIO**: Valuable, Rare, Inimitable, Organised — all four = sustained advantage.
- **Five fits**: environmental, vertical, internal, intra-function, intra-activity.
- **Integrative model**: Internal vs External × Process vs Outcomes.
- **Four archetypes**: Commitment (Int+Out), Collaborative (Ext+Out), Paternalistic (Int+Proc), Traditional (Ext+Proc).

MODULE 2

Recruitment & Selection

Sessions 3 & 4 — Building a pool of candidates, then choosing the right one

2.1 Overview — recruitment vs selection

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Part 1 – Recruitment: definition; effective recruitment; person–environment fit; ASA framework; internal and external sources; measuring source effectiveness; job redesign; workforce planning; personnel needs projection; yield pyramid.

Part 2 – Selection: why selection matters; structured vs unstructured interviews; interview content types; interview formats; selection tests; reliability; validity; errors and biases.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Recruitment = attracting many good people to apply (widening the net). **Selection** = picking the best one from those who applied (narrowing down).

EXAMPLE

For a cricket team: holding open trials across the state so 2,000 youngsters show up is **recruitment**. Watching them play and choosing the final 15 is **selection**.

2.2 What is recruitment?

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

“The process of attracting the interest of a pool of capable people who will apply for jobs within an organization.”

- People can choose where to work, so organisations must attract them (in a recession choices may be limited).
- A person may be capable, but how far that will be realised is not fully predictable.
- How capability is understood increasingly depends on the organisation’s **talent management** approach.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Recruitment is like **marketing the company to job seekers**. Good people have options, so you must make your job attractive. Even then, hiring is a bit of a bet — a great CV doesn’t guarantee great performance.

EXAMPLE

An IT company advertises “hybrid work, learning budget, fast promotions” to attract coders who also have offers from rivals. During a recession, when jobs are scarce, the same company gets many applicants even without such perks.

2.3 What is effective recruitment?

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Effective recruitment depends on how far the overall management philosophy supports an HR approach that focuses on **using and developing new employees** after they join.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Hiring good people is only half the job. Recruitment is truly “effective” when the company **uses their skills and helps them grow** once they join.

EXAMPLE

A company hires a top MBA graduate but makes her do only data entry for a year. She leaves. The recruitment wasn’t effective — not because of hiring, but because the company didn’t use or develop her.

2.4 Person–Environment (P-E) fit

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

P-E fit is the degree of match between an individual and some aspect of the work environment. Five types are shown.

Item	Simple meaning	Example
Person–Job (P-J)	Your skills match what the job needs, and the job gives you what you want.	A good-with-numbers person in an accounts job.
Person–Vocation (P-V)	You are in the right kind of career/profession for you.	Someone who loves helping people chooses nursing or teaching.
Person–Person (P-P)	You match with a specific person — boss, mentor or colleague.	You and your manager both like clear, direct communication.
Person–Group (P-G)	You fit in with your immediate team.	A fun-loving, fast-paced person joins an energetic young sales team.
Person–Organisation (P-O)	Your values match the company’s values and culture.	An eco-conscious person working for a sustainability-focused company.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Fit happens at many levels. You can be great at the job (P-J) and still be unhappy if you don’t gel with the team (P-G) or company values (P-O).

EXAMPLE

A brilliant salesperson (good P-J) who values honesty quits a firm that pushes staff to mis-sell products (poor P-O).

2.5 The Attraction–Selection–Attrition (ASA) framework

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

A cycle around **Organisation Goals**: Attraction → Selection → Attrition.

- A theory of interactional psychology: organisations differ because people are attracted to their goals, interact with them, and "if they don't fit, they leave."
- **Work values** are the main way people judge P-O fit. People seek organisations similar to themselves; organisations select people similar to them. Values can be compared "directly and meaningfully".
- At the heart are **organisational goals**, set by the founder and/or top managers; from them come the structures and processes that guide attraction.

Stage	Simple meaning	Example
Attraction	People are drawn to companies whose goals and values feel like their own.	Adventurous people apply to a start-up; security-seekers apply to a PSU.
Selection	The company picks people who seem similar to itself.	The start-up chooses risk-takers in interviews.
Attrition	People who don't fit eventually leave.	A cautious person who joined the start-up quits after 6 months.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Over time, a company fills up with similar kinds of people. This creates a strong culture — but can also reduce diversity of thinking.

EXAMPLE

Think of Apple under Steve Jobs: his goals (design perfection) attracted design-obsessed people, Apple selected them, and those who didn't share that passion left.

2.6 Building the candidate pool

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Channels: job fairs, walk-ins, college recruitment, websites & job portals (LinkedIn/Naukri/Indeed/Monster), newspaper ads, executive hiring agencies/placement consultants.

Internal: IJPs, rehires, referrals, succession planning. **External:** job portals, ATS & career sites, job fairs, walk-ins, campus drives, agencies & consultants.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

The **candidate pool** is the group of people who apply. You fill it from two directions: from **inside** the company, and from **outside**.

EXAMPLE

A bank needs 10 branch managers. It posts the jobs internally for current officers (internal) and also puts ads on Naukri and LinkedIn (external).

2.7 Internal sources of recruitment

Item	Simple meaning	Example
Internal Job Postings (IJP)	Vacancies announced to current employees first.	An email: “Team Lead role open in Pune — current staff may apply.”
Rehiring	Bringing back former employees (“boomerang” hires).	An engineer who left for a start-up rejoins her old company 2 years later.
Succession planning	Preparing insiders to take over key roles in future.	The deputy CFO is groomed for 3 years to become CFO when the current one retires.
Referrals	Employees recommend people they know.	You refer your college friend and get a referral bonus if she is hired.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Looking inside first is **cheaper and faster**, the person already knows the culture, and it motivates staff because they see growth. The downside: fewer fresh ideas.

2.8 External sources of recruitment

Source	Simple meaning	Example
Recruitment via internet	Online job portals, company career sites, social media.	Posting on Naukri, LinkedIn, Indeed.
Texting / emails about jobs	Sending job alerts directly to phones/inboxes.	An SMS: “Walk-in for BPO jobs this Saturday.”
Job fairs (virtual / in-person)	Many employers meet many job seekers at one event.	A university job fair with 50 companies’ stalls.
Advertising	Ads in newspapers, radio, TV, hoardings.	Times Ascent newspaper job ads.
Employment agencies	Agencies that find candidates for a fee.	A local agency supplying office staff.
Temp agencies & alternate staffing	Supply temporary or contract workers.	Extra delivery staff hired through an agency for Diwali season.
Executive recruiters	“Headhunters” who find senior leaders.	A search firm finding a new CEO.
On-demand recruitment services	Recruiters hired per project, paid by the hour/project.	A start-up hires a freelance recruiter to fill 20 roles in a month.
College recruiting	Campus placements, site visits, internships.	IIM campus placements; summer internships turning into job offers.
Referrals and walk-ins	Recommendations; people who come to the office directly to apply.	A candidate walks into a hotel and asks for a job opening.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Going outside brings **new skills and fresh ideas** — useful when no insider has the skill or the company is growing fast. It usually costs more and takes longer.

2.9 Measuring source effectiveness

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Three measures: **Cost of hire** (= total costs ÷ number of leads; logistics, ATS, advertising, agency commissions); **Quality of hire** (culture fit, competency fit, growth potential, learning capability, agility); **Timeliness of hire** (turnaround time in days, offer conversion rate, how many can join immediately).

Measure	Simple meaning	Example
Cost of hire	How much money a channel costs per candidate. Includes travel/stay, applicant tracking system (ATS) software, ads, agency fees.	Spent ₹2,00,000 on a job fair that gave 400 leads → ₹500 per lead.
Quality of hire	Were the people actually good? Do they fit the culture, have the skills, learn fast, adapt, and have growth potential?	Campus hires stay longer and get promoted more than walk-in hires → campus gives better quality.
Timeliness of hire	How fast the job is filled; what % of offers are accepted; how many can join at once.	Agency fills role in 15 days; campus hire joins only after 6 months.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

To know which channel works best, check three things: **Is it cheap? Is it good? Is it fast?** Usually you can't get all three from one source.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

Cost of hire formula on the slide: **Total costs ÷ Number of leads**.

2.10 Job redesign

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Job enlargement: assigning additional activities at the same level.

Job enrichment: redesigning jobs to increase responsibility, achievement, growth and recognition.

Job rotation: systematically moving workers from one job to another.

Method	Simple meaning	Example
Job enlargement	**More** tasks of the same level (horizontal).	A receptionist also handles courier and meeting-room booking.
Job enrichment	**Deeper**, more meaningful work with more responsibility (vertical).	The receptionist is allowed to handle visitor complaints and train new front-desk staff.
Job rotation	**Different** jobs one after another.	A management trainee spends 3 months each in sales, HR and finance.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Before hiring someone new, a firm can reshape existing jobs. This can cover small gaps, reduce boredom and develop staff.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)
Enlargement = **wider**; Enrichment = **deeper**; Rotation = **move around**.

2.11 Workforce planning

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Workforce (employment/personnel) planning is deciding **what positions the firm will have to fill and how to fill them** — from maintenance clerk to CEO.

Process: **Employment planning & forecasting → Recruiting (build a pool) → Applicants fill application forms → Selection tools screen applicants → Interview & final hiring decision.**

IN SIMPLE WORDS
Planning ahead for people, just like a shop plans stock before the festive season. Decide how many people you'll need, which roles, and when — then find, screen and choose them.

EXAMPLE
An e-commerce company expects double orders during the Big Billion Days sale. In July it plans: 500 extra warehouse staff, 50 customer-care agents, 5 supervisors. Then it recruits, screens, interviews and hires them before October.

2.12 Personnel needs projection (how many people will we need?)

Method	Simple meaning	Example
Trend analysis	Look at how staff numbers changed over the last few years and continue the pattern.	Staff grew 100 → 110 → 120 over 3 years, so next year we expect about 130.
Ratio analysis	Use a past ratio between a cause (e.g. sales) and the staff needed.	1 salesperson handles ₹50 lakh sales. Next year's target is ₹10 crore → need 20 salespeople.
Scatter plot	A graph showing how two things (e.g. sales and staff) move together; forecast one to estimate the other.	Plot hospital beds vs nurses for 8 hospitals; a 500-bed hospital will need about 240 nurses based on the line.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)
Trend = past pattern of **staff** over time. Ratio = staff linked to a **business factor**. Scatter = **graph** of two variables.

2.13 The recruiting yield pyramid

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
From experience, the firm knows: offers to new hires = **2:1**; interviewed to offers = **3:2**; invited to interviewed = **4:3**; leads to invited = **6:1**.

Stage	Ratio	Meaning
Leads → Invited	6 : 1	Of every 6 applicants, only 1 is invited for interview

Stage	Ratio	Meaning
Invited → Interviewed	4 : 3	Of 4 invited, 3 actually turn up
Interviewed → Offers	3 : 2	Of 3 interviewed, 2 get offers
Offers → New hires	2 : 1	Of 2 offers, 1 accepts and joins

IN SIMPLE WORDS

The yield pyramid tells you **how many applicants you need at the start** to end up with the number of hires you want — because people drop out at every stage.

EXAMPLE

Need **50 new hires**? Work backwards:

- 50 hires × 2 = **100 offers**
- 100 offers × 3/2 = **150 interviews**
- 150 interviews × 4/3 = **200 invitations**
- 200 invitations × 6 = **1,200 leads**

So you must attract about **1,200 applicants** to get 50 people to join.

2.14 Why is employee selection important?

Reason	Simple meaning	Example
Person–job fit	Make sure the person can actually do the job well.	Checking a driver can drive safely before hiring.
Person–organisation fit	Make sure the person suits the company's culture and values.	A customer-first company checks that a candidate is patient and polite.
Avoid negligent hiring	The employer can be held legally responsible if it hires someone it should have known was unsafe or unsuitable.	A school hires a staff member without a background check; he harms a child → the school is liable.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

A wrong hire costs money (salary, training, re-hiring), harms team morale and customers, and can even bring legal trouble. Careful selection prevents this.

2.15 How structured are interviews?

	Unstructured (non-directive)	Structured (directive)
What it is	No set format; no right or wrong answers; flows like a conversation	Pre-decided, job-related questions with pre-determined (expected) answers
Good for	Building rapport; exploring unusual answers	Fair comparison; better prediction of job performance
Example	"So, tell me about yourself… oh, you like trekking? Tell me more."	Every candidate is asked the same 8 questions and scored on a 1–5 scale for each.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Unstructured = **casual chat**. Structured = **same exam paper for everyone**. Structured is fairer because everyone is compared on the same basis.

2.16 Interview content: four question types

Type	Simple meaning	Sample question
Situational	Asks how you **would** handle a **hypothetical** (future) situation.	“What would you do if two team members kept fighting?”
Behavioural	Asks how you **did** handle a **real** situation in the past.	“Tell me about a time you handled a conflict in your team.”
Job-related	Asks about relevant past job experience.	“In your last job, how did you manage the inventory system?”
Stress	Deliberately makes you uncomfortable with often-rude questions, to spot over-sensitive people and test stress tolerance.	“Your answers are weak. Why should we waste time on you?”

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

Situational = **“What WOULD you do?”** (future). Behavioural = **“What DID you do?”** (past).

2.17 How interviews are conducted (formats)

Format	Simple meaning	Example
Unstructured sequential	Several interviewers meet you one after another; each asks whatever they like.	HR, then the manager, then the director — each with their own questions.
Structured sequential	Several interviewers one after another, each using a standard form.	Each interviewer scores you on the same rating sheet.
Panel interview	A group of interviewers questions you together.	UPSC interview board of 5 members.
Mass interview	A panel interviews several candidates at once.	Group discussion with 8 candidates in campus placements.
Phone interview	Conducted over telephone, often for first screening.	A 15-minute HR call to check salary expectations.
Computer-based	Candidate answers questions presented by a computer.	An online test with timed multiple-choice questions.
Web-based	Over video tools or recorded video platforms.	A Zoom/Teams interview, or recording answers on HireVue.

2.18 Types of selection tests

Test	Simple meaning	Example
Cognitive ability	Tests thinking power: reasoning, verbal comprehension, memory, numbers. IQ tests (Stanford-Binet, Wechsler) and aptitude tests.	CAT-style aptitude test used by banks and IT companies.
Motor & physical ability	Tests hand-finger skill, coordination, strength. Crawford Small Parts Dexterity, Stromberg Dexterity, Purdue Peg Board.	Asking a mobile-assembly worker to fit tiny screws and pins quickly.
Personality & interest	Measures personality and interests. **Projective** (Rorschach inkblot, TAT) uses vague pictures; **non-projective** (Myers-Briggs) uses clear questions.	Inkblot: "What do you see here?" MBTI: "Do you prefer parties or quiet evenings?"
Achievement	Measures knowledge you have **already learned** for the job.	A typing test, coding test or accounting test.
Computerised multimedia	Assessment through computer/multimedia simulations.	A game-based test where you manage a virtual shop.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Cognitive = how well you **think**. Motor = how well your **hands/body** work. Personality = **who you are**. Achievement = what you **already know**. In a **projective** test you "project" your inner mind onto an unclear picture.

2.19 Reliability of selection tests

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

A reliable test gives **consistent scores** when a person takes two alternate forms of the test, or the same test on different occasions.

Method	Simple meaning	Example
Test-retest	Same test, same people, two different times; compare scores.	Candidates take the same aptitude test on Monday and again next Monday; scores should be similar.
Equivalent / alternate form	Two different but equal versions of the test; compare scores.	Set A and Set B of a question paper — a student should score similarly on both.
Internal comparison	Items in the same test that measure the same thing should give consistent answers.	Five questions measuring honesty in one test: a person should answer them in a consistent way.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Reliability = **consistency**. If a weighing scale shows 60 kg today and 72 kg tomorrow for the same person, it's unreliable — you can't trust it.

2.20 Validity of selection tests

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Validity tells you whether the test **measures what it is supposed to measure**.

Type	Simple meaning	Example
Criterion validity	Statistics show that people who score high on the test also **perform better on the job**.	Salespeople with high scores on a sales-aptitude test actually achieve higher sales.
Content validity	The test content **represents important parts of the job** — it looks like the job.	A typing test for a data-entry operator; a driving test for a driver.
Construct validity	The test truly measures an invisible quality (a "construct") **and** that quality matters for success.	A test of "conscientiousness" really measures carefulness, and carefulness predicts good work for auditors.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

Reliability = consistent. Validity = correct/relevant.

A watch that is always 10 minutes fast is **reliable** (consistently fast) but **not valid** (wrong time). A good test must be both.

2.21 Errors and biases in selection

Error	Simple meaning	Example
First impressions	Snap judgments in the first few minutes colour the whole interview.	A candidate arrives late due to traffic; the interviewer ignores his strong answers afterwards.
Not clarifying job requirements	If interviewers don't know what the job needs, they judge on gut feeling and inconsistently.	Two interviewers hire for "a good person" — one means friendly, the other means technical.
Candidate-order (contrast) effect & pressure to hire	A candidate looks better or worse compared with the one just before; urgency lowers standards.	An average candidate seen after three poor ones seems excellent. A manager desperate to fill a role by Friday hires the first okay person.
Nonverbal behaviour & impression management	Interviewers give too much weight to confidence, eye contact, smiles and self-promotion.	A smooth talker gets selected over a more skilled but shy engineer.
Personal characteristics	Looks and other personal traits unconsciously affect decisions.	Preferring tall, good-looking candidates, or those from your own hometown or college.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Interviewers are human, so their judgment can be bent by small things. Structured interviews, clear job criteria and multiple interviewers reduce these errors.

2.22 Key takeaways

- Recruitment builds the candidate pool; selection chooses the right fit from it.
- Effective recruitment depends on sourcing strategy and the organisation's talent management.
- Track cost, quality and timeliness of hire to know which sources actually work.

Module 2 — Quick revision

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

- Recruitment = attract; Selection = choose.
- 5 P-E fits: Job, Vocation, Person, Group, Organisation.
- ASA: Attraction → Selection → Attrition around organisational goals.
- Internal sources: IJP, rehire, referrals, succession planning. External: portals, ads, agencies, campus, headhunters, etc.
- Source effectiveness: Cost, Quality, Timeliness of hire.
- Job redesign: enlargement, enrichment, rotation.
- Forecasting: trend, ratio, scatter plot. Yield pyramid: 6:1, 4:3, 3:2, 2:1.
- Interview content: situational, behavioural, job-related, stress.
- Tests: cognitive, motor, personality/interest, achievement, multimedia.
- Reliability (test-retest, alternate form, internal) vs Validity (criterion, content, construct).
- Biases: first impression, unclear requirements, contrast/pressure, nonverbal, personal characteristics.

MODULE 3

International HRM: From Expatriates to Digital Nomads

International assignments, staffing mindsets, cross-cultural adjustment and the networks that help people thrive abroad

3.1 Session plan and the opening question “Would you go?”

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Session flow: opening question → history of international work → types of assignments → staffing mindsets (EPRG) → break → adjustment & dual allegiance → U-curve vs J-curve → prior international academic experience → developmental networks → mini case → wrap-up.

Opening question: Your company offers a 3-year posting abroad, leaving in 60 days. What would make you say yes? What would make you say no? Who would you need on your side?

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Working abroad is a big life decision that affects career, money, family and feelings. This module studies how companies and people handle it.

EXAMPLE

Yes because: higher salary, faster promotion, global exposure. **No** because: spouse’s job, child’s school, ageing parents. **Who you need:** family support, a helpful boss at HQ, friendly local colleagues.

3.2 How international work has evolved

Period	What happened	In simple words / example
Before 1945	Trading companies and colonial administrations posted merchants and officials abroad (East India Company). Expatriation as **control**.	Sending trusted people to rule and control far-off places — e.g. British officers posted to India.
1950s–1970s	Post-war MNC expansion; HQ sends parent-country “company men” on long-term packages (Edström & Galbraith, 1977).	Big US/European firms send their own managers abroad for years with big perks.
1980s–1990s	Worries about cost and “expatriate failure” (Tung, 1981; later questioned by Harzing, 1995). Localisation, TCNs and inpatriation grow.	Expats are too costly and some return early, so firms hire locals or other nationalities instead.
Late 1990s–2000s	Individuals take charge: overseas experience (Inkson et al., 1997) and self-initiated expatriation (Suutari & Brewster, 2000). Alternative assignments spread (Collings et al., 2007).	People move abroad on their own — e.g. an Indian engineer applies directly for a job in Dubai.
2010s	Global careers and global talent management; edu-immigrants; clearer definitions of mobility (Baruch et al., 2013; Andresen et al., 2014).	Students study in Canada or Australia and stay on to work there.
2020 onwards	COVID-19 normalises remote work; digital nomadism goes mainstream; countries launch digital-nomad visas.	A designer works for a US client from Goa this month and from Bali next month.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)
Big shift: from **company-led** (sent by employer) → to **individual-led** (people choose to go themselves).

3.3 Three faces of international work

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Key question: **Who decides, who pays, and who carries the risk?**

	Assigned expatriate	Self-initiated expatriate (SIE)	Digital nomad
Who starts it	The organisation	The individual	The individual
Who pays	Employer funds relocation and package	Hired on local terms (no special package)	Little or no employer support
Return	Return job usually planned	No guaranteed return	Keeps moving every few weeks/months
Career	Tied to one employer	Owned by the person	Lifestyle and autonomy first; location-independent
Example	Infosys sends a manager to London for 3 years	A nurse from Kerala applies herself to a UK hospital	A freelance writer working from Lisbon, then Bali

IN SIMPLE WORDS
The more the **company** decides, the more it pays and carries the risk. The more the **individual** decides, the more they carry the risk themselves.

3.4 Why do organisations send people abroad?

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS
Edström & Galbraith (1977): three reasons.

Reason	Simple meaning	Example
Position filling	Fill a job where local talent or technical skill isn't available.	An Indian car company sends an engineer to its new plant in Africa because local engineers lack that technology skill.
Management development	Give high-potential employees international experience to prepare them as future leaders.	A bright young manager is posted to Singapore for 2 years before becoming regional head.
Organisation development	Build control, coordination and a shared culture across all units.	Senior HQ managers are posted to subsidiaries so that every office follows the same values and systems.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)
3 reasons: **Fill** a gap, **Develop** a manager, **Connect** the organisation.

3.5 Who goes? The staffing vocabulary

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Example used on slides: an Indian MNC with a subsidiary in Germany.

Term	Simple meaning	Example
PCN – Parent-country national	Citizen of the HQ country, working in a foreign subsidiary.	An Indian manager of the Indian MNC posted to Germany.
HCN – Host-country national	Citizen of the subsidiary's country, working there.	A German manager working in the German subsidiary.
TCN – Third-country national	Citizen of neither the HQ nor the host country.	A Singaporean manager of the Indian MNC posted to Germany.
Inpatriate	An HCN or TCN brought **into HQ** for a period.	A German manager moved to the Indian HQ in Mumbai.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

P = **Parent** (home of HQ), H = **Host** (where the office is), T = **Third** (neither), Inpat = coming **in** to HQ.

3.6 Types of international assignments

Group 1 — Company-led, traditional

Assignment	Scope & tenure	Purpose & who goes	Problems	Example
Long-term assigned expatriate	Full relocation, often with family; 1–5 yrs (often ~3)	Position filling, management development, control; PCN senior managers/specialists chosen by HQ	Very high cost; family adjustment; dual-career strain; early return; repatriation and retention	TCS sends a delivery head with family to the US for 3 years
Short-term	Defined project, usually without family; 3–12 months	Project delivery, skills transfer, troubleshooting, start-ups; specialists, project managers, high-potentials	Family separation; tax/compliance limits; little time to adjust; burnout	An engineer goes to Brazil for 6 months to set up a new plant
Inpatriate	HCN/TCN moved into HQ; months to a few years	Learn corporate culture, develop global leaders, bring local knowledge to HQ; high-potential subsidiary managers	"Outsider" at HQ; little influence; unclear career on return	A Japanese manager spends 2 years at the Mumbai HQ

Group 2 — Alternative and flexible

Assignment	Scope & tenure	Purpose & who goes	Problems	Example
Commuter	Lives at home, travels weekly/fortnightly; ongoing, reviewed yearly	Cover a foreign role without moving family; managers in neighbouring countries/regional roles	Fatigue; work–life strain; tax and social-security complexity; weak local ties	A manager lives in Bengaluru and flies to Dubai every Monday, back Friday
Rotational	Fixed on/off cycles at remote sites (e.g. 28 days on/28 off), family at home	Staff remote locations (oil & gas, mining, offshore); technical/operational staff	Isolation; fatigue and safety risks; family disruption; little cultural integration	An offshore oil-rig engineer: 4 weeks on the rig, 4 weeks at home
International business traveller ("frequent flyer")	Frequent short trips, no relocation; days to weeks	Meetings, sales, audits, deal-making; sales staff, executives, auditors, consultants	Travel stress and health; family strain; often invisible to HR; compliance risk	A sales director flies to 3 countries in a month for client meetings

Group 3 — Individual-led and boundaryless

Assignment	Scope & tenure	Purpose & who goes	Problems	Example
Virtual	Cross-border responsibility managed from home via technology; ongoing or per project	Cut cost, lead global teams; post-COVID default; managers of global/regional teams	Low face-to-face trust; time zones; cultural misreading; "out of sight" for development	A manager in Pune leads a team spread across the US, UK and Philippines over Zoom
Self-initiated expatriate	Moves abroad on own initiative, hired locally; open-ended, often long	Person: career, adventure, lifestyle. Firm: talent at local cost. Professionals, academics, nurses, edu-immigrants	No HQ package or support; underemployment; visa dependence; no safety net	An Indian student finishes a master's in Canada and takes a job there
Digital nomad	Location-independent remote worker moving between countries; weeks–months per place	Person: autonomy and lifestyle. Firm: remote talent. Freelancers, tech/creative workers, remote employees	Tax/residency/legal grey zones; employer "permanent establishment" risk; loneliness; weak social protection	A UX designer working for clients online while living in Thailand, then Portugal

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Each type **solves one problem but creates another**. Long-term expats give control but are expensive. Commuters keep families at home but get exhausted. Virtual work saves money but builds less trust.

"**Permanent establishment**" risk: if an employee works from another country, that country's tax office may say the company is doing business there and must pay tax.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

Choose the assignment type for its **purpose**, not out of habit.

3.7 Staffing mindsets — EPRG (Perlmutter)

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Perlmutter (1969); regiocentric added by Heenan & Perlmutter (1979).

Mindset	What it means	Plus (+)	Minus (−)	Example
Ethnocentric	Key posts held by PCNs; HQ ways imposed everywhere	Control; easy communication with HQ	Glass ceiling for locals; cultural blind spots; costly	A Japanese car maker where all top managers in its Indian plant are Japanese
Polycentric	Subsidiaries run by locals (HCNs); HQ run by PCNs	Local knowledge; lower cost; continuity	Gap between HQ and subsidiary; locals rarely move up or abroad	Hindustan Unilever run mainly by Indian managers
Geocentric	Best person for the job, any nationality	Global talent pool; global mindset	Expensive; visas; complex pay and policies	Microsoft and Google appointing Indian-born CEOs (Satya Nadella, Sundar Pichai)
Regiocentric	Managers move within a region (e.g. Asia-Pacific)	Regional integration; some local fit	Regional silos; limited path to global HQ	An Asia-Pacific head office in Singapore moving managers between India, Malaysia and Australia

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Ethno = “Home knows best.” **Poly** = “Let locals run local.” **Geo** = “Best person from anywhere.” **Regio** = “Think in regions.”

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

Memory trick: **E**thnocentric = **E**verything from home; **G**eocentric = **G**lobal.

3.8 Spotting ethnocentrism in everyday practice

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Ethnocentrism rarely announces itself. Six signals:

Signal	Simple meaning	Example
1. “The HQ way is the best way”	Assuming home methods are always better.	HQ refuses a local marketing idea because “we don’t do it like that in India.”
2. Templates exported unchanged	Using HQ appraisal and pay forms abroad without adapting them.	US-style forced ranking imposed on a team in Japan, where it clashes with group harmony.
3. Top roles always PCNs	Every subsidiary head is from the HQ country.	All country heads of an Indian firm are Indians, even in Germany and Brazil.
4. HQ language and time zone	Meetings run in HQ language at HQ-friendly hours.	Global call at 10 am IST means US colleagues join at midnight.
5. Local ideas need HQ validation	Locals can’t act without HQ approval.	A Brazilian manager waits 3 weeks for HQ to approve a small local promotion.
6. Locals “not yet ready”	Local staff repeatedly called not ready for leadership.	A capable Kenyan manager is passed over again for an HQ expat.

EXAMPLE

Geocentric versions: rotate meeting times; adapt appraisal forms to local culture; let the best person, of any nationality, head each unit.

3.9 A comprehensive model of international adjustment

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Black, Mendenhall & Oddou (1991): two phases (anticipatory and in-country) and three facets (work, interaction, general).

Phase A — Anticipatory adjustment (before leaving)

Factor	Simple meaning	Example
Previous overseas experience (individual)	Having lived abroad before makes moving easier.	Someone who studied in the UK settles faster when posted to London.
Pre-departure cross-cultural training (individual)	Training about the new culture before you go.	A 2-day workshop on German business etiquette and basic German.
Accurate expectations (individual)	Knowing what life really will be like.	Knowing beforehand that shops close on Sundays in Germany.
Selection mechanisms & criteria (organisational)	The company picks the right person using the right criteria — not just technical skill.	Choosing someone adaptable and open-minded, and checking family readiness.

Phase B — In-country adjustment (after arriving)

Factor	Simple meaning	Example
Individual: self-efficacy, relational & perceptual skills	Self-belief, ability to build relationships and read situations correctly.	A confident, friendly person who notices local customs adjusts faster.
Job: role clarity, discretion, novelty, conflict	Clear role and freedom help; a very new or conflicting role makes it harder.	An expat with a clear job description and decision power settles well.
Organisation: culture novelty, social support, logistics help	How different the company culture is; help from colleagues; help with housing etc.	The company arranges an apartment, a buddy and a bank account on day one.
Socialisation tactics and content	How the newcomer is introduced and taught the ropes.	A structured induction programme with a local mentor.
Non-work: culture novelty, spouse & family adjustment	How different daily life is, and how well the family settles.	If the spouse is lonely and the child unhappy at school, the expat struggles too.

Three facets of adjustment

Facet	Simple meaning	Example
Work	Comfortable with the job, tasks and work standards.	Understanding how meetings and deadlines work in the new office.
Interaction	Comfortable dealing with local people.	Being able to chat easily with local colleagues and neighbours.
General (living)	Comfortable with daily life — food, housing, transport, shopping, health care.	Knowing where to buy groceries and how to use the metro.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Settling abroad starts **before** you leave and continues **after** you land. You can be fine at work but still struggle with daily life — these are separate areas.

3.10 Dual allegiance — where does the expatriate's heart lie?

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Black & Gregersen (1992). Two dimensions: allegiance to the **parent firm (HQ)** and to the **local operation**.

	LOW local allegiance	HIGH local allegiance
HIGH HQ allegiance	**Hearts at home** (the homesick): loyal to HQ, distant from the local unit; keeps comparing with home.	**Dual citizens**: committed to both; bridges the two. **The ideal.**
LOW HQ allegiance	**Free agents** (drifting/confused): committed to neither; career-driven; likely to leave either side.	**Going native**: acts like a local; identifies with the local unit; resists HQ direction.

Type	Simple meaning	Example
Hearts at home	Body abroad, heart at HQ.	An Indian manager in Paris who keeps saying "In India we do it better" and avoids French colleagues.
Dual citizens	Loyal to both; acts as a bridge.	Explains HQ's goals to the local team and the local market's needs to HQ.
Free agents	Loyal to no one; focused on own career.	Uses the posting to build a CV and jumps to a rival company abroad.
Going native	Fully sides with the local unit.	Starts ignoring HQ instructions, saying "HQ doesn't understand this market."

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

The ideal expat is a **dual citizen** — a bridge between HQ and the local unit.

3.11 The U-curve of adjustment

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Lysgaard (1955); Oberg (1960) on culture shock; Torbiörn (1982) with expatriates.

Stage	Simple meaning	Example
1. Honeymoon	Excitement and novelty; seeing everything like a tourist.	First weeks in Paris: cafés, the Eiffel Tower, everything is wonderful.
2. Culture shock	Frustration, anxiety, homesickness as familiar cues stop working.	Month 3: can't speak French, bank paperwork is slow, misses home food.
3. Adjustment	Learning the rules, building routines and friendships.	Month 6: learns basic French, finds a favourite market, makes friends.
4. Mastery	Working effectively and feeling comfortable.	Year 1: feels at home and performs well at work.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Feelings go **up → down → up again**, like the letter **U**.

3.12 The J-curve — not everyone gets a honeymoon

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Research since the 1990s challenges the U-curve:

- **Hardest at entry:** difficulties peak on arrival and ease over time — no initial high (Ward et al., 1998).
- **Steady climb:** work adjustment rose gradually over 9 months, not in a U (Zhu et al., 2016).
- **Prior experience shifts the curve:** culture-specific work experience changed the path (Zhu et al., 2016); prior experience and training ease adjustment (Koo Moon et al., 2012).

IN SIMPLE WORDS

For many people there is **no honeymoon**. The first weeks are the hardest (finding a house, documents, new job), and things just get better over time — like the letter **J**.

EXAMPLE

A manager lands in Tokyo, can't read signs, struggles with a rented flat and visa paperwork from day one. There's no "excitement" phase — but each month gets steadily easier. Someone who has worked in Japan before starts higher and climbs faster.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

U-curve = **high → low → high**. J-curve = **start low → keep rising**. Experience and training change the shape.

3.13 Intelligent career competencies (knowing-why, -how, -whom)

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Arthur, Claman & DeFillippi (1995); DeFillippi & Arthur (1994). Used in Ray & Maheshwari (2022), "Being There, Done That, Known This, and Known That".

Link: international academic experience works like self-initiated expatriation (students choose the country). It builds all three competencies and helps edu-immigrants handle uncertainty abroad.

Competency	Simple meaning	Example
Knowing-why	Your motivation, identity and meaning — why you want this career and why abroad.	“I want to work abroad because I love learning new cultures and want a global career.”
Knowing-how	Skills and knowledge, including cultural knowledge, that help you perform.	Data-analytics skills plus knowing how Germans run meetings (punctual, direct).
Knowing-whom	Relationships and networks that give career, information and emotional support.	Classmates, professors and alumni in Germany who refer you for jobs.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

Why = **motivation**; How = **skills**; Whom = **network**.

3.14 How academic exposure builds career competencies (Propositions 1–3)

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Ray & Maheshwari (2022).

Proposition	Simple meaning	Example
P1 → Knowing-how: Source of cultural knowledge	Cosmopolitan campuses expose students to the host culture and many others — new problem-solving styles, languages, ways of decoding culture.	An Indian student in Australia learns Australian informality and also how Chinese and German classmates solve problems.
P2 → Knowing-whom: Studying in multicultural groups	Shared classrooms, housing and activities build ties with host and other nationals. Sticking only with your own nationality weakens this.	Living in a hostel with Kenyan, French and local students builds a global network; mixing only with Indians doesn’t.
P3 → Knowing-why: Enabler of global employment	A first successful adaptation sparks an “urge to travel”, makes future postings feel less scary, and builds interest in international firms.	After a good exchange year in Spain, a student actively seeks jobs at MNCs with overseas postings.

3.15 Length versus breadth of experience (Propositions 4–5)

	LENGTH — years in one country	BREADTH — number of countries
Benefits	Deep cultural embeddedness and strong ties; rich, tacit know-how of that culture	Culturally diverse, wide networks; knowledge usable across cultures; less prejudgement of the unexpected; motivation for international careers
Downsides	Networks become dense and repetitive; can reduce the “boundaryless” nature of the career	—
Proposition	**P4:** Longer stays → more knowing-how, -whom and -why about **that** culture	**P5:** Greater breadth → more knowing-how, -whom and -why about cultural **diversity**
Example	6 years in Japan → a Japan expert, ideal for a Japan-specific role	1 year each in the UK, UAE, Singapore and Brazil → comfortable anywhere, ideal for a global role

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Length = depth (expert in one culture). **Breadth = variety** (flexible across many cultures).

3.16 What this means for global talent management

Lesson	Simple meaning	Example
Experience alone is not enough	Experience must turn into real knowledge to become dynamic cross-cultural competence (Caligiuri & Tarique, 2012).	Someone who lived in the US for 2 years but never mixed with Americans gained little.
Experience can substitute for training	With enough prior experience, less cross-cultural training may be needed (Koo Moon et al., 2012).	A manager who studied in Germany may not need the full German-culture workshop.
Match experience to the role	Country-specific roles → same-country experience. Global leadership roles → breadth.	Send the person who studied in France to head the French office; pick a multi-country person as global head.
Watch long stays	Long stays can weaken ties with HQ and commitment, raising intentions to quit.	An expat 8 years in London starts feeling more British than “company” and joins a local firm.
No experience or training?	Developmental networks help them thrive (Ray & Maheshwari, 2021).	A first-time expat is given a local buddy, an HQ mentor and an expat peer group.

3.17 Combining lifelines to thrive — a stage-based need-fulfilment network

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Ray & Maheshwari (2021), *Journal of Global Mobility*. Assignees’ needs change across the stages of an assignment; **no single mentor can meet them all**.

Four developers around the international assignee: **host-country nationals** (intra-organisational), **parent-country nationals** (intra-organisational), **fellow expatriates** (peer developers), **family** (extra-organisational). Each plays several need-based mentoring roles, and the role shifts by stage.

Developer	What they offer	Example
Host-country nationals (local colleagues)	Local know-how, how work is done here, practical help.	A German colleague explains office rules and helps find a flat.
Parent-country nationals (HQ colleagues)	Link to HQ, career sponsorship, information about home opportunities.	Your Mumbai boss keeps you visible for promotions while you’re away.
Fellow expatriates (peers)	Shared experience, emotional support, insider tips.	Other Indian expats in Frankfurt tell you where to get Indian groceries and good schools.
Family (outside work)	Emotional support and stability throughout.	Your spouse’s encouragement on hard days.

Activity: “Who helps when?” — a sample answer

Stage	Host-country nationals	Parent-country nationals	Fellow expatriates	Family
Before departure	Information about the location (if contact exists)	Career: why this posting matters; info from those who went before	Practical tips via online groups	Emotional: joint decision, support
Arrival & settling in	Practical: housing, bank, local rules	Information: who’s who locally	Emotional + practical: “we’ve been there”	Emotional: adjusting together
Mid-assignment	Information: local work norms; friendship	Career: stay visible to HQ, sponsorship	Emotional: shared experiences	Emotional: stability
Return home	—	Career: finding the next role at HQ	Information: how others managed re-entry	Emotional: readjusting at home

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Think of a **team of lifelines**, not one guru. Different people help with different needs (career, information, emotional, practical) at different stages.

3.18 Mini case: Meera in Frankfurt (fictional)

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Meera, 36, IT delivery manager with an Indian MNC, on a 3-year assignment in Frankfurt. Her husband left his job to join her; their son is 8. She did one exchange semester in Singapore years ago; no cross-cultural training. At month 4 she calls her Bengaluru team daily, eats mostly at Indian restaurants, finds German colleagues “rude”. HQ asked her to roll out the Indian appraisal system unchanged. Her husband is isolated at home.

Suggested answers to the diagnostic questions

Question	Answer
Dual-allegiance quadrant?	**Hearts at home** — strong ties to HQ/India (daily calls, Indian food, comparing), weak ties to the local unit.
U or J curve?	She’s in a low phase at month 4. If she had an early high → culture-shock dip of the **U**. If it was hard from day one → **J**. No training, a very different culture, and her husband’s isolation explain it.
HQ’s staffing mindset?	**Ethnocentric** — exporting the Indian appraisal system unchanged.
Did Singapore help?	Only a little: short (low **length**), one different country (low **breadth**), and long ago — little Germany-specific know-how.
Who should step in?	**HCNs**: explain German direct communication (not “rude”). **Fellow expats**: emotional support, tips, and a network for her husband. **PCNs/HQ**: adapt the appraisal system, arrange cross-cultural training. **Family**: support for her husband (language classes, job search, spouse groups).

3.19 Five ideas to take away

- International work has moved from **organisation-led to individual-led**: assigned expatriates → self-initiated expatriates → digital nomads.

- Each assignment type solves one problem and creates others — choose it for the purpose, not by habit.
- Staffing mindsets shape who gets ahead; ethnocentrism hides in everyday templates and meetings.
- Adjustment is not always a U; prior experience and training change the shape of the curve.
- Prior international academic experience builds knowing-how, -whom and -why; where it is missing, a developmental network of lifelines fills the gap.

3.20 Key references (for citing in answers)

Andresen et al. (2014); Arthur, Claman & DeFillippi (1995); Baruch et al. (2013); Black & Gregersen (1992); Black & Mendenhall (1990); Black, Mendenhall & Oddou (1991); Caligiuri & Tarique (2012); Collings, Scullion & Morley (2007); DeFillippi & Arthur (1994); Edström & Galbraith (1977); Heenan & Perlmutter (1979); Inkson et al. (1997); Koo Moon, Kwon Choi & Shik Jung (2012); Lysgaard (1955); Oberg (1960); Perlmutter (1969); Ray & Maheshwari (2021, 2022); Suutari & Brewster (2000); Torbiörn (1982); Ward et al. (1998); Zhu et al. (2016).

Module 3 — Quick revision

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

- Three faces: assigned expatriate, self-initiated expatriate, digital nomad.
- Why send abroad (Edström & Galbraith): position filling, management development, organisation development.
- PCN, HCN, TCN, Inpatriate.
- 9 assignment types in 3 groups: company-led, flexible, individual-led.
- EPRG: Ethnocentric, Polycentric, Regiocentric, Geocentric.
- Adjustment model (Black, Mendenhall & Oddou): anticipatory + in-country; facets = work, interaction, general.
- Dual allegiance: hearts at home, dual citizens (ideal), free agents, going native.
- U-curve: honeymoon → shock → adjustment → mastery. J-curve: hardest at entry, steady climb.
- Knowing-why / how / whom; P1–P3; length (depth) vs breadth (variety).
- Developmental network: HCNs, PCNs, fellow expats, family — roles change by stage.

MODULE 4

Mentoring and Coaching

The why, what and how of developmental relationships

4.1 Mentoring — two people, one developmental relationship

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Mentor: senior and experienced; often comes from a school of thought; imparts wisdom, knowledge and skills.

Mentee / protégé: brings career goals and aspirations; sets the direction the mentoring serves.

The relationship is **two-way**.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

A mentor is a wise guide who has walked the road before you. But it's the mentee's goals that decide where the journey goes — the mentee steers, the mentor guides. Both learn from each other.

EXAMPLE

A young HR executive who wants to become an HR head is mentored by a senior HR director. She sets the goal ("I want to learn strategic HR"); he shares experience and advice. In return, she teaches him how new HR tech tools work.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

Protégé = another word for mentee.

4.2 Why? What is in it for the mentor?

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Mentoring is not one-way giving — it pays back the mentor too: fulfilment, rise in self-esteem, career progression, succession planning, networks, …and more.

Benefit	Simple meaning	Example
1. Fulfilment	The satisfaction of helping someone grow.	A senior manager feels proud when her mentee wins "Best Employee".
2. Rise in self-esteem	Feeling valued and respected for your experience.	A 55-year-old engineer feels his knowledge still matters when juniors seek his advice.
3. Career progression	Developing people is a leadership skill that helps your own promotion.	A manager known for building strong juniors is promoted to department head.
4. Succession planning	You prepare someone to take your place, freeing you to move up.	A branch manager trains his deputy so he can be promoted to regional manager.
5. Networks	You connect with the mentee and their circles, and learn new ideas.	Through her mentee, a director connects with young start-up founders.
…and more	Other gains, such as learning new trends from younger people.	A mentee teaches the senior how to use AI tools and Instagram marketing.

4.3 What? The two functions of mentoring

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Function 1 – Career mentoring: exposure, networking, sponsorship, coaching, protection of a less-experienced protégé. **Function 2 – Psychosocial mentoring:** counselling, friendship, role-modelling. Coaching sits inside the career function: mentors coach, but coaching is only one part of what they offer.

Function 1 — Career mentoring (helps you get ahead)

Part	Simple meaning	Example
Exposure	Getting you noticed by important people.	Mentor lets you present your project to the CEO.
Networking	Introducing you to useful contacts.	Mentor introduces you to the head of marketing at a conference.
Sponsorship	Actively recommending you for roles and promotions.	In the promotion meeting, your mentor says “She’s ready — give her the role.”
Coaching	Teaching specific skills and strategies.	Mentor coaches you on how to negotiate with a difficult client.
Protection	Shielding a less-experienced protégé from risky situations or unfair blame.	When your first project slips, your mentor explains to the boss that the deadline was unrealistic.

Function 2 — Psychosocial mentoring (helps you feel confident and grow as a person)

Part	Simple meaning	Example
Counselling	Listening and helping with worries and doubts.	You’re unsure whether to take a transfer; your mentor helps you think it through.
Friendship	A warm, personal, caring bond.	Lunch together, where you talk about life, not just work.
Role-modelling	Showing by their own example how to behave and work.	You watch how calmly your mentor handles an angry customer and copy that style.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Career function = helps your **job/career**. **Psychosocial function** = helps your **confidence, identity and well-being**.

Mentoring vs coaching: coaching focuses on specific skills or performance; mentoring is broader, covering the whole career and person. So coaching is **one part** of mentoring.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

Career: **E-N-S-C-P** (Exposure, Networking, Sponsorship, Coaching, Protection).
Psychosocial: **C-F-R** (Counselling, Friendship, Role-modelling).

4.4 Who? Who becomes your mentor — or your mentee?

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

Similarity: we are drawn to people who share our demographics, education background, work, city, college and gender.

Most important — values congruence: shared values deepen the bond and build closeness.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

We usually connect first with people who are **like us** (same college, same city, same field). But a mentoring bond becomes deep and lasting only when both share the same **values** — what each believes is important.

EXAMPLE

You and a senior are both IIM alumni from Pune — that gets you talking (similarity). The relationship grows strong because you both deeply value honesty and work–life balance (values congruence).

4.5 Making it work — three anchors for the relationship

Anchor	Simple meaning	Example
1. Similarity	Start from shared ground and look for shared values.	Begin by talking about your common college or interests, then discuss what matters to each of you.
2. Expectations	Make clear early what each side expects.	Agree in the first meeting: meet once a month, focus on leadership skills, keep conversations confidential.
3. Exit	Plan the ending so it adds value for both.	After one year, a final review meeting: celebrate progress and agree to stay in touch as friends.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Find common ground, set the rules early, and plan a good goodbye — so the relationship ends well instead of fizzling out or turning sour.

4.6 How? Build a developmental network

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

A multiplicity of mentors: no single mentor serves every function. Several developers share the career and psychosocial work between them.

Strong ties: higher closeness and higher frequency of contact. (Diagram: protégé in the centre; Mentors A and B with strong ties; Mentors C and D with weaker ties.)

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Don’t depend on one mentor for everything. Build a small **personal board of advisers** — different people for different needs. Some are close and frequent (**strong ties**); others are occasional (**weak ties**). Both are useful: strong ties give trust and support; weak ties bring new information and opportunities.

EXAMPLE

A young marketing manager's network:

- **Mentor A (strong tie)** — her boss: sponsorship and exposure.
- **Mentor B (strong tie)** — a former professor: counselling and friendship.
- **Mentor C (weaker tie)** — a senior from another company met at a conference: industry information and networking.
- **Mentor D (weaker tie)** — an alumni contact abroad: advice on global careers.

4.7 Over time — how a mentoring relationship unfolds

WHAT THE SLIDE SAYS

The slide plots **intensity** over **time** through four phases: Initiation → Growth → Decline → Redefinition. **Breach of trust** causes an abrupt fall.

Phase	Simple meaning	Example
Initiation	The relationship starts; you get to know each other; intensity begins rising.	First 3–6 months: a few meetings, building trust.
Growth	Intensity peaks; most learning, support and sponsorship happen.	Years 1–2: regular meetings, mentor sponsors you for a big project.
Decline	Mentee becomes independent and needs less help; intensity falls naturally.	You get promoted and start leading your own team; meetings become rare.
Redefinition	The relationship settles into a new, stable form — often friendship or peers.	Years later, you and your ex-mentor are friends who meet for coffee and exchange ideas as equals.

EXAMPLE

Breach of trust: if a mentee shares the mentor's confidential advice with others, or a mentor takes credit for the mentee's work, the relationship can **collapse suddenly** instead of declining gently.

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

Normal path: **Initiation → Growth → Decline → Redefinition**. A breach of trust = **sudden fall**.

4.8 Reflect — questions for your own mentoring map

Question	What it means	Example answer
1. Who is in your developmental network today?	List the people who guide and support you.	Boss, a college professor, a senior friend, a parent.
2. Which career and psychosocial functions are missing?	Check which of the 8 functions nobody gives you.	Lots of friendship and counselling, but nobody sponsoring you for promotions.
3. What do you expect from each relationship — and how will it end well?	Be clear about the purpose and plan a good exit.	"From my boss I want exposure for 1 year; we'll review at appraisal time."

IN SIMPLE WORDS

Draw yourself in the centre and your mentors around you. Spot the gaps (e.g. no sponsor, no role model) and look for someone to fill each one.

Module 4 — Quick revision

REMEMBER (EXAM TIP)

- Mentor (senior, imparts wisdom) ↔ mentee/protégé (sets direction); two-way.
- Benefits for mentor: fulfilment, self-esteem, career progression, succession planning, networks.
- Career function: exposure, networking, sponsorship, coaching, protection.
- Psychosocial function: counselling, friendship, role-modelling. Coaching is part of the career function.
- Who: similarity draws people; values congruence matters most.
- Three anchors: similarity, expectations, exit.
- Developmental network: many mentors; strong ties vs weaker ties.
- Phases: initiation → growth → decline → redefinition; breach of trust = abrupt fall.